

Martillano, Kient Justine A.

BA Communication 4A

Instructor: Dwight Michael Sunico

Reflection Paper – 4th National References

Guest speaker Mr. Jade Abayari Oraña's "Art of Film as Bridge for Social Dialogue and Lenses of Perspective" articulates the importance of film as an outlet for expressions, education, and creating awareness of social issues. A major epiphany I had while viewing this session relates to how film, through storytelling, connects people from diverse backgrounds through a range of experiences (ie. Real life experiences), difficulties, and points of view. As a result, audiences can develop an understanding of situations they have not personally encountered.

The film creates a bridge for social dialogue by providing a space for individuals to share their thoughts, feelings, and interpretations on various topics. For example, social justice issues, identity politics and/or inequality. These subject areas provide opportunities for discussion and introspection. Therefore, film has the capacity to create a forum that allows for diverse voices to be represented and to engage in constructive conversations that would otherwise be challenging.

One of the other key areas of learning from the session was how storytelling is an invaluable means in which to alter or develop perspective. Storytelling is central to every film and how the story is told influences the audience's perception of reality. A strong narrative can offer a challenge to existing stereotypes, provide the audience with new ways of thinking about the world, and create an opportunity to promote greater feelings of empathy. I learned through the session that storytelling is both a creative process and a process of responsibility. Filmmakers have the ability to develop narrative frames that reinforce stereotypes and biases or challenge the target's way of thinking.

Cinema has long been regarded as one of the most effective communication mediums because it consists of combining three forms of information like visual, auditory and kinesthetic to effectively communicate a message. Unlike the majority of other mediums,

films provide the viewer with a sensory overload by providing information from all three modes of communication simultaneously like visual, auditory and kinesthetic. The sensory overload provides viewers with a much greater opportunity to retain the message, films can successfully simplify complex issues and present them in an easily understood manner to a greater audience. Also, the films have the potential to be an effective educational tool, promote awareness or positively impact an individual's opinion and or behaviour.

Social awareness and change are a massive effect of filmmakers shaping their perceptions through their storytelling decisions. If filmmakers choose to tell certain stories or choose how to portray those stories, filmmakers can expose important social issues that are not discussed in society today. Movies can help create movements, inspire people to take action, and provide a means for communities to voice their needs.

Also, with this power comes the responsibility of being truthful, ethical, and sensitive when creating film projects based on the realities depicted in a film.

I, as a communication student, believe that applying principles of film will be very beneficial to me in my future work, whether I choose media production, journalism, or digital communication as my career path. I can apply effective storytelling techniques when creating my content so that I can create information that is informative as well as inspiring and engaging for my audiences. I can also use film and media to improve social awareness, develop dialogue, and make positive contributions to my community.

The session has helped me realize how film is not only a method of entertainment, it is also a very powerful tool to help shape people's ideas about each other and create understanding between different groups of people, and provide a way for people to create a plan for social change. It has provided me with a new motivation to be an efficient communicator as well as an efficient and responsible communicator in my future careers.